

DARE TO DREAM?

It's too early to look at the standings, but the Sox can feel good about themselves after ending April without falling out of contention, writes Paul Sullivan. **Sports**



CHICAGOLAND
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Court diminishes Voting Rights Act

EFFECTS IN ILLINOIS: Hours after the high court ruling, Illinois Senate President Don Harmon announced that a state constitutional amendment to enshrine protections for majority-minority districts will not appear on the November ballot. **Chicagoland, Page A5**

Justices’ ruling to strike down mostly Black district in La. could have wide consequences

By Mark Sherman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Wednesday weakened a landmark Civil Rights-era law that has increased minority represen-

tation in Congress and elsewhere, striking down a majority Black congressional district in Louisiana and opening the door for more redistricting across the country that could aid Republican efforts to control the House.

In a 6-3 ruling, the court’s conservative majority found that Louisiana district represented by Democrat Cleo Fields relied too heavily on race. Chief Justice John Roberts had described the 6th Congressional District as a “snake” that stretches more than 200 miles to link parts of Shreveport, Alexandria, Lafayette and Baton Rouge. “That map is an unconstitutional

gerrymander,” Justice Samuel Alito wrote for the six conservatives. The effect of the ruling may be felt more strongly in 2028 because most filing deadlines for this year’s congressional races have passed. Louisiana, though, may have to change its redistricting plan to comply with the decision.

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STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

HIT THE DIRT

Kapuki, an eastern black rhinoceros, emerges from the barn with her new female calf, Hazina, at the Lincoln Park Zoo on Wednesday in Chicago. It was Hazina’s first time outside since her birth on March 19. The calf peeked out the door several times earlier in the day before crossing the threshold at 1:47 p.m. and trotting across the mud after her mother. **Chicagoland, Page A2**

After 5 high-profile decades, lawyer steps away

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

When it comes to an effective cross-examination, longtime Chicago attorney Joseph Duffy says there’s nothing better than confronting a witness with a document.

“If a witness is telling a story, there is only so far you can go,” Duffy told the Tribune in an interview this week. “But if you’ve got a document that is totally inconsistent with what they are saying, then you’ve got him. They can’t move off it. And there is not a jury in the world that likes a liar.”

It’s an art that Duffy mastered over his decades as a trial lawyer, both as a federal prosecutor and later in white-collar defense. He once used bar receipts to show that an undercover agent had been lying about how many drinks he bought an allegedly corrupt yen trader during an investigation at

the Chicago Mercantile Exchange in the 1980s. “He said maybe one or two. I pulled out this receipt that said it was 12 beers,” Duffy said. Decades later, Duffy’s seven-day cross-examination of FBI mole Stuart Levine during the trial of

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Shooting reveals holes in system

As alleged cop killer put monitor in ‘sleep mode,’ hours dragged

By Caroline Kubzansky,
Olivia Olander
and Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

About seven weeks before Alphonso Talley allegedly snuck a gun into a Lincoln Square hospital and shot the pair of cops guarding him, his electronic monitor went into “sleep mode” and officials lost track of him.

The chief judge’s office had tightened its electronic monitoring violation policy over the winter, instituting a new requirement that any absence longer than three hours would need to be reviewed by a judge within a day. The policy still gave judges the discretion on whether to issue a warrant in the event of an absence.

In Talley’s case, the presiding judge did issue a warrant. But he did so at a hearing that took place more than 48 hours after the violation occurred, per court records — about double the time required under the new policy.

Talley’s device shut off at 7:44 a.m. March 9. Under the new policy, the violation should have gone before John Lyke, the judge on Talley’s case, March 10.

As Lyke noted in a court transcript of that hearing reviewed by the Tribune, it was 1:06 p.m.

See **SHOOTING** on Page A4

■ Indiana woman who bought the gun used in the shooting at Swedish Hospital remains jailed. **Chicagoland, Page A4**

‘We were dealing with what we had’

Former West Suburban Medical Center staffers detail poor conditions leading up to its closure

By Cam’ron Hardy
PIONEER PRESS

When Sallanshell Wilson saw a family member of one of her patients walking down a lengthy hall at West Suburban Medical Center with a cane, she noticed that every few steps the woman slouched to the right.

At that moment, Wilson thought, “If she had a walker, that will keep her more stable and possibly prevent her from falling,” she said.

Wilson, a former registered nurse at the hospital, took it upon herself to buy a walker for the woman, paying for it out of her own pocket. “God gave me that to do,” Wilson said. “He let me know, hey, you can prevent a fall today.” In scenarios like these, she’d often tell patients the same thing when they could regain the ability to walk properly: “I’ll see you at the mall.” Wilson is just one of hundreds of employees who lost their job earlier

this month after officials announced West Suburban Medical Center was temporarily shutting down last month amid a longstanding financial crisis. West Suburban and its sister hospital, Weiss Memorial Hospital, were acquired by Resilience Healthcare from Pipeline Health System in 2022. Weiss closed down in 2025 after its Medicaid funding out of compliance with rules related to nursing services, physical environment and emergency services.

West Suburban’s closure was a

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Nurse Sallanshell Wilson describes sentimental items kept in a display case at her home on Wednesday in Chicago. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**

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